VENDOR PROCUREMENT · NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE

Enterprise Campus Network Monitoring System

This document defines our requirements for the procurement of an enterprise-grade network monitoring platform. Responding vendors are expected to demonstrate full alignment with all Must Have requirements specified herein.

Document Title	Enterprise Campus Network Monitoring System — BRD
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Issued By	Network Procurement Office — IT Infrastructure Division
Deployment Scope	On-Premises · Up to 1,000 Nodes · Multi-Site Campus
Compliance	NCA ECC 2018 · ISO/IEC 27001
Classification	**Confidential — Vendor Use Only**

DOCUMENT

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DOCUMENT HISTORY

Revision History

VERSION	DATE	AUTHOR	DESCRIPTION
1.0	May 2026	Business Analysis Team	Initial internal draft
2.0	June 2026	IT Procurement Team	Revised for vendor distribution — reframed as procurement BRD; added evaluation criteria, commercial requirements, and vendor response instructions

PRIORITY KEY SUMMARY

Requirements in this document are classified as **Must Have (M)** — disqualifying if not met; **Should Have (S)** — weighted in scoring; **Could Have (C)** — low-weight differentiator. See Appendix A for full definitions.

SECTION 1

1 Executive Summary

We operate a large-scale enterprise campus network serving clinical, administrative, and research functions. We are procuring an enterprise-grade network performance monitoring platform to strengthen our network visibility and operational capabilities.

This BRD defines the full scope of functional requirements, non-functional requirements, integration needs, compliance obligations, and commercial expectations. Vendors are invited to respond with a formal proposal demonstrating how their solution meets each stated requirement. The selected platform must provide complete, real-time visibility into network infrastructure health, performance, and availability from a centralized, web-based console deployed on-premises within our on-premises data center.

SECTION 2

2 Organization & Current Environment

2.1 About the Organization

We are a healthcare institution operating an enterprise-grade network spanning campus buildings, data centers, and clinical zones. Our network infrastructure is primarily Cisco. All network devices have SNMP enabled with standardized credentials across the estate.

2.2 Current Monitoring Environment

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT STATE
Approx. Scale	~1,000 monitored nodes (current); growth target to be confirmed within 24 months
Sites	1 primary campus site; 1 remote WAN-connected site
Deployment Model	On-premises, Windows Server
Active Integrations	Email notifications, SNMP traps (no Active Directory/LDAP currently deployed)
Primary Users	NOC team, Network Engineering, IT Management

2.3 Drivers for Change

Operational Visibility

A unified monitoring platform is essential to maintaining proactive visibility across our campus network and reducing MTTR.

TCO Reduction

Lower total cost of ownership over a 3-year horizon is a key selection criterion.

Vendor Independence

Eliminate single-vendor lock-in for network observability infrastructure.

Long-Term Roadmap

Require a vendor with demonstrated product stability and an active 3-year development roadmap.

SECTION 3

3 Business Problem Statement

Without a unified, real-time monitoring platform, our IT Operations team faces the following operational risks:

PROBLEM AREA	IMPACT
Reactive incident response	Outages detected by end-user complaints rather than proactive alerting — extends MTTR
Monitoring blind spots	Multi-vendor infrastructure produces fragmented visibility with no single pane of glass
No root cause correlation	Performance degradation cannot be traced across L2/L3 without automated dependency mapping
Absent capacity planning	Bandwidth saturation and hardware refresh decisions are reactive without trending data
Compliance reporting gaps	Uptime SLAs, audit trails, and availability metrics must be generated manually
No traffic visibility	Cannot identify top bandwidth consumers, rogue applications, or abnormal traffic in real time

SECTION 4

4 Project Objectives & Success Metrics

COVERAGE **≥98%** Managed devices discovered within 48 hrs of deployment	**ALERT LATENCY** **≤60s** Threshold breach to notification delivery	**MTTR REDUCTION** **≥35%** vs. baseline within 90 days of go-live
CONSOLE UPTIME **99.9%** Platform availability SLA for monitoring console	**NOC ADOPTION** **100%** NOC operators trained and live within 30 days	**CUTOVER GAP** **0** Zero monitoring gap during platform go-live and cutover

SECTION 5

5 Scope

5.1 In Scope

- Device discovery, inventory & classification (SNMP, ICMP, CDP/LLDP)
- Real-time SNMP polling — CPU, memory, interface metrics
- NetFlow / sFlow / IPFIX traffic collection & analysis
- Layer 2 & Layer 3 topology discovery & mapping
- Threshold-based & anomaly alerting with escalation
- Drag-and-drop dashboards & pre-built NOC views
- Scheduled reporting (PDF, Excel, HTML)
- RBAC with local user account management
- REST API for ITSM integration
- High-availability (HA) deployment architecture
- Cisco device support (primary infrastructure); vendor must confirm multi-vendor extensibility for future use

5.2 Out of Scope

- Application Performance Monitoring (APM)
- Log aggregation / SIEM / SOAR
- Configuration backup & change management (NCM)
- Endpoint or agent-based security monitoring
- SD-WAN / SASE-specific monitoring
- Mobile native applications

5.3 Key Constraints

Deployment	On-premises only — no cloud SaaS
Data Residency	All data stays within our on-premises environment
Compliance	NCA ECC 2018 mandatory
Transition	No monitoring gap during cutover

SECTION 6

6 Stakeholders

STAKEHOLDER	ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	ENGAGEMENT
IT Operations Director	Primary Sponsor	Approve requirements and budget; final sign-off	High
Network Engineering Team	Subject Matter Expert	Validate monitoring requirements and device coverage	High
NOC Manager	End User Representative	Define alerting workflows, dashboard needs, NOC workflows	High
IT Security Team	Reviewer	Validate access control, data security, compliance requirements	Medium
Procurement Team	Evaluation Coordinator	Coordinate vendor evaluation, requirement alignment, and selection process	High
Executive Leadership	Executive Sponsor	Final investment decision and budget governance	Low

SECTION 7

7 Functional Requirements

All requirements are tagged with priority: Must Have Should Have Could Have. Must Have items are disqualifying if not natively supported. See Appendix A for full definitions.

7.1 Device Discovery & Inventory

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-01	Automated ICMP ping sweep across user-defined IP ranges or CIDR subnets to discover all live hosts	Must Have	CIDR notation support required
FR-02	Poll and manage devices via SNMP v1, v2c, and v3 with configurable community strings and v3 auth/priv credentials	Must Have	
FR-03	Use CDP and LLDP to discover adjacent devices and build neighbor tables automatically	Must Have	
FR-04	Import and parse custom MIB files to extend monitoring to proprietary or niche device types	Should Have	MIB browser preferred
FR-05	Auto-classify discovered devices by type: router, switch, firewall, server, wireless AP, printer, UPS	Must Have	
FR-06	Schedule recurring discovery scans (hourly, daily, weekly) with delta reporting of new/removed devices	Must Have	
FR-07	Live device inventory view with filterable columns: device name, IP, type, vendor, OS version, status, last polled	Must Have	
FR-08	Bulk device import via CSV for large-scale on-boarding	Should Have	

7.2 Real-Time Performance Monitoring

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-09	Poll device CPU and memory utilization via SNMP at configurable intervals (default 60s; minimum 30s)	Must Have	
FR-10	Monitor interface-level metrics per port: bandwidth utilization (in/out), error rate, discard rate, packet loss	Must Have	Per-interface granularity required
FR-11	Real-time up/down status with color-coded indicators: green (up), red (down), yellow (warning), grey (unknown)	Must Have	
FR-12	Calculate and display device response time (latency) via ICMP round-trip time per device	Must Have	
FR-13	Retain raw performance data minimum 90 days; aggregated hourly/daily data minimum 2 years	Must Have	Configurable retention policy
FR-14	WMI polling for Windows servers: disk I/O, service status, process CPU	Should Have	
FR-15	SNMP trap reception and correlation with polled device state	Must Have	
FR-16	Interface utilization trend sparklines or heat maps within device detail views	Should Have	

7.3 Network Traffic Analysis (Flow)

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-17	Receive and parse NetFlow v5/v9, sFlow v5, and IPFIX records (UDP listener, configurable port, default 2055)	Must Have	
FR-18	Classify traffic by application using NBAR / DPI signatures; display top-N applications by bandwidth	Must Have	
FR-19	Display top talkers by source IP, destination IP, protocol, and port with conversation-level drill-down	Must Have	
FR-20	Historical flow analysis with selectable time ranges: 1h, 6h, 24h, 7d, 30d, and custom range	Must Have	
FR-21	Alert on bandwidth utilization thresholds per interface or aggregate circuit capacity	Must Have	Integrates with alert engine
FR-22	Per-VLAN and per-subnet traffic breakdown	Should Have	
FR-23	Identify and flag anomalous traffic patterns (e.g., port scans, sudden bandwidth spikes)	Should Have	

7.4 Topology Discovery & Mapping

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-24	Auto-generate Layer 2 topology maps using CDP/LLDP neighbor discovery data without manual input	Must Have	
FR-25	Generate Layer 3 routing topology maps using OSPF/BGP tables retrieved via SNMP	Should Have	
FR-26	Overlay live device health status on topology maps using color-coded status indicators	Must Have	
FR-27	Custom network maps with drag-and-drop device placement and optional background floor plan images	Must Have	
FR-28	Export topology maps as PNG, PDF, or SVG	Should Have	
FR-29	Link utilization levels shown on map edges with color graduation (green/amber/red)	Must Have	
FR-30	Topology map drill-down — clicking a device opens its detail/performance view	Must Have	

7.5 Alerting & Notification Engine

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-31	Threshold-based alerts on any monitored metric: CPU %, memory %, interface utilization, packet loss, device up/down	Must Have	
FR-32	Multi-condition alert rules using AND/OR boolean logic across multiple metrics and device groups	Must Have	
FR-33	Notifications via: email (SMTP), SMS (HTTP gateway), webhook (outbound JSON POST), SNMP trap forwarding	Must Have	All four channels required
FR-34	Alert escalation policies — auto-escalate to next tier if unacknowledged within configurable time window	Should Have	
FR-35	Maintenance windows (one-time and recurring) that automatically suppress alerts for planned downtime	Must Have	
FR-36	Dependent alert suppression — suppress child device alerts when upstream parent is confirmed down	Must Have	Root cause suppression
FR-37	Alert acknowledgement, annotation, and assignment to operators from within the console	Must Have	
FR-38	Alert history log with search, filter, and export capability	Must Have	
FR-39	Alert deduplication to prevent notification flooding for flapping devices	Must Have	

7.6 Dashboards & Reporting

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-40	Drag-and-drop dashboard builder with widget types: gauge, line chart, bar chart, table, topology tile, status summary	Must Have	
FR-41	Out-of-the-box dashboards: Executive Summary, NOC Real-Time Overview, Interface Detail, Top-10 Bandwidth Users, Device Health	Must Have	
FR-42	Scheduled reports delivered via email in PDF, Excel, and HTML formats	Must Have	
FR-43	SLA availability reporting per device or group: uptime %, MTTR, MTBF, downtime events over configurable date ranges	Must Have	
FR-44	Capacity planning reports that trend current utilization and project when thresholds will be exceeded	Should Have	Linear trend minimum
FR-45	Report templates saveable and shareable across user accounts	Should Have	
FR-46	Dashboard sharing via read-only public URL or embedded iFrame (NOC wall display use case)	Should Have	

7.7 Access Control & User Management

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-47	RBAC with built-in roles: Administrator, Operator, Read-Only; plus custom role creation with granular permission assignment	Must Have	
FR-48	Integration with Microsoft Active Directory and LDAP for user authentication and group-to-role mapping	Could Have	Not currently deployed; future requirement only
FR-49	SAML 2.0 for single sign-on (SSO) integration	Could Have	Not currently required
FR-50	Organizational unit-based device visibility scoping — users only see devices within their assigned scope	Must Have	
FR-51	Tamper-evident audit log of all user actions: login/logout, config changes, alert acknowledgements, report generation	Must Have	
FR-52	Account lockout policy after configurable number of failed login attempts	Must Have	

7.8 API & External Integration

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	NOTES
FR-53	Documented REST API (JSON) for programmatic read/write access to devices, alerts, metrics, and configuration	Must Have	
FR-54	Outbound webhook triggers on alert state changes (open, acknowledged, resolved)	Must Have	
FR-55	Native or documented integration with ServiceNow for automatic incident creation on critical alerts	Should Have	
FR-56	Receive syslog messages from network devices and correlate with polled device state	Should Have	
FR-57	SNMP trap reception from managed devices	Must Have	

SECTION 8

8 Non-Functional Requirements

8.1 Performance

ID	REQUIREMENT	TARGET / METRIC
NFR-01	Dashboard load time for standard views with up to 500 devices	**< 3 seconds**
NFR-02	Full polling cycle duration for 10,000 monitored interfaces	**< 60 seconds**
NFR-03	NetFlow / sFlow / IPFIX record ingestion and processing throughput	**≥ 100,000 flows/s**
NFR-04	Alert trigger latency from threshold breach to notification delivery	**< 60 seconds**
NFR-05	Search / filter response across full device inventory	**< 2 seconds**

8.2 Scalability

ID	REQUIREMENT
NFR-06	Support at least **5,000 monitored nodes** and **100,000 monitored interfaces** in a single deployment
NFR-07	Distributed polling architecture must support horizontal scaling by adding polling engines with no platform reinstall
NFR-08	Database architecture must maintain query performance as historical data grows beyond 1 TB
NFR-09	Support at least **50 concurrent authenticated web console users** without performance degradation

8.3 Availability & Reliability

ID	REQUIREMENT
NFR-10	Platform shall maintain **99.9% uptime** for the monitoring console (< 8.76 hours unplanned downtime/year)
NFR-11	Hot-standby HA configuration must achieve failover within **60 seconds** with no data loss
NFR-12	All configuration and historical data backed up daily with minimum 30-day backup retention
NFR-13	Distributed polling engines must continue collecting data independently if central server is temporarily unreachable

8.4 Security

ID	REQUIREMENT
NFR-14	All web console traffic served over HTTPS (TLS 1.2 minimum; TLS 1.3 preferred)
NFR-15	SNMP v3 credentials stored encrypted at rest (AES-256 minimum)
NFR-16	User passwords stored using strong one-way hashing algorithm (bcrypt or Argon2)
NFR-17	Session timeout after 30 minutes of inactivity (administrator-configurable)
NFR-18	Third-party OWASP Top 10 vulnerability assessment completed within the past 24 months; report available on request
NFR-19	No monitoring data, device credentials, or telemetry transmitted to any external cloud service

8.5 Usability

ID	REQUIREMENT
NFR-20	Web console fully functional on Chrome, Firefox, Edge (Chromium), and Safari (latest 2 major versions)
NFR-21	UI responsive and functional at 1280×800 minimum resolution
NFR-22	New administrator able to complete initial device discovery and receive first alert within 4 hours of installation
NFR-23	In-product contextual help or searchable knowledge base accessible from within the console

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SECTION 9

Technical Environment

9.1 Current Network Infrastructure

CATEGORY	DETAILS
Network Vendors	Cisco (all network devices)
Protocols in Use	SNMP v2c/v3, OSPF, BGP, CDP, LLDP
Flow Export	NetFlow v9 (Cisco)
SNMP Readiness	100% of devices SNMP-enabled; standardized credentials; all versions (v1/v2c/v3) supported
Sites	1 primary campus site; 1 remote WAN-connected site requiring proxy or buffered polling config
Authentication	Local accounts (no Active Directory or LDAP currently deployed)
ITSM Platform	ServiceNow
Server OS	Windows Server 2019/2022, RHEL 8/9, Ubuntu 22.04 LTS

9.2 Deployment Requirements

DEPLOYMENT MODEL

On-premises only. Cloud-connected SaaS models are **not acceptable**. A VM is already provisioned. Vendor must provide resource specifications (vCPU, RAM, storage) suited for ~1,000 nodes initial scale with a clear upgrade path.

REQUIREMENT	DETAILS
Supported OS	Windows Server 2019/2022 and/or Linux (RHEL 8/9 or Ubuntu 22.04 LTS)
Virtualization	VMware vSphere — VM pre-provisioned; vendor to provide resource specifications (vCPU, RAM, storage) based on 1,000-node starting scale
High Availability	Active-passive HA required — vendor must describe architecture in proposal
Database	Vendor must describe embedded or external DB engine and provide storage sizing guidance

9.3 Integration Points

SYSTEM	INTEGRATION TYPE	REQUIREMENT
Active Directory / LDAP	LDAP / LDAPS	Not currently deployed — future integration capability required (Could Have)
ServiceNow	REST webhook outbound	Auto-create incidents from critical alerts
Email Server	SMTP with TLS	Alert notifications and scheduled report delivery
SMS Gateway	HTTP API	Critical alert SMS via third-party gateway
Syslog	UDP/TCP	Receive device syslog events
External APIs	REST (JSON)	Programmatic read access for third-party tooling

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SECTION 10

Compliance & Regulatory Requirements

All aspects of the solution — data storage, access control, encryption, and audit logging — must comply with the following. Vendors must explicitly state compliance posture against each item in their proposal.

STANDARD / REGULATION	RELEVANCE & EXPECTATION
NCA ECC 2018 (KSA)	Saudi National Cybersecurity Authority Essential Controls — governs monitoring tool data handling, access management, and encryption. **Mandatory compliance.**
HIPAA (where applicable)	Our organization handles patient data. Network monitoring systems must not inadvertently capture or expose PHI. Vendor must confirm scope.
ISO/IEC 27001	Vendor must confirm that their development and delivery processes are ISO 27001 certified or in active pursuit. Certificate or status letter required.
GDPR (informational)	Applicable to any data processed on behalf of non-KSA entities. Vendor must clarify data processing scope and confirm no data leaves the on-prem environment.

SECTION 11

11 Vendor Evaluation Criteria

#	CRITERION	WEIGHT
1	**Functional Coverage** — percentage of Must Have requirements met natively (no customization)	30%
2	**Scalability & Performance** — proven ability to support 5,000+ nodes and 100,000+ interfaces	15%
3	**Security & Compliance** — encryption, RBAC, audit logging, NCA ECC alignment, ISO 27001	15%
4	**Total Cost of Ownership (3-year)** — license, maintenance, support, and infrastructure costs	15%
5	**Vendor Stability & Roadmap** — years in market, customer base size, active development commitment	10%
6	**Migration & Transition Ease** — tooling for device discovery import, configuration migration, and parallel-run support	8%
7	**Support Quality** — SLA tiers available, KSA or MENA region support presence, dedicated TAM	7%

11.1 Shortlisting Process

Step 1 — RFI Review

Proposals evaluated against FR/NFR requirements matrix. Vendors failing Must Have items are disqualified.

Step 2 — Reference Check

Minimum 2 enterprise references (≥1,000 nodes). GCC or healthcare sector references preferred.

Step 3 — POC (max 3 vendors)

Shortlisted vendors conduct a 30-day on-site or remote POC against a defined test plan.

Step 4 — Commercial Award

Final pricing submitted after POC conclusion. Contract awarded within 2 weeks of commercial close.

SECTION 12

12 Commercial & Licensing Requirements

Vendors must address all of the following in their proposal response:

REQUIREMENT	DETAILS
Licensing Model	State clearly: perpetual vs. subscription; per-node, per-interface, per-user, or unlimited
3-Year TCO	Full 3-year cost breakdown: license fees, annual maintenance/support, implementation services, training
POC Pricing	Confirm whether a fully-featured POC license can be provided at no cost during the evaluation period
Scalability Pricing	Clarify pricing for starting node count (~1,000) and scaling path to 5,000+ nodes
Module Pricing	If flow analysis, topology, or reporting are separate modules, itemize each cost separately
Support Tiers	Describe available support tiers (business hours, 24×7, dedicated TAM) and associated annual cost
Payment Terms	State preferred terms: annual, multi-year upfront; specify any multi-year discount
KSA Partner	Confirm whether a KSA-based authorized reseller or implementation partner is available

SECTION 13

13 Implementation & Support Requirements

13.1 Implementation

- Formal implementation project plan within 10 business days of contract award
- Parallel running period of **minimum 30 days** alongside our existing monitoring solution during cutover
- Initial device discovery and onboarding support for the first 500 devices
- All documentation (installation, admin, user guides) provided in English

13.2 Training

- Administrator training: minimum **2 days** live instructor-led (in-person or virtual)
- NOC operator training: minimum **1 day** practical session
- Training materials (slides, video, or e-learning) for self-paced refresher use

13.3 Ongoing Support SLA

PRIORITY	INITIAL RESPONSE
P1 — Critical	≤ 4 hours · 24×7
P2 — High	≤ 8 hours · business hours
P3 — Medium	≤ 24 hours · business hours

- Dedicated support channel: ticketing portal, email, and phone
- Security patches delivered within 30 days of release
- Named KSA or MENA region technical account contact preferred

SECTION 14

14 Acceptance Criteria

The solution will be accepted for production when all of the following are verified through User Acceptance Testing (UAT):

ID	ACCEPTANCE CRITERION	TEST METHOD
AC-01	Discovery scan completes across a /24 subnet and returns all live devices within 5 minutes	Live test
AC-02	SNMP polling accurately reflects actual CPU and interface state within 2 polling cycles of a real change	Lab test
AC-03	Alert fires and email notification is received within 60 seconds of a threshold breach	Live test
AC-04	Topology map correctly displays all discovered CDP/LLDP neighbors and links for a 50-device test network	UAT review
AC-05	NetFlow data from a Cisco router correctly populates top-talker and top-application views	Lab test
AC-06	A Read-Only user cannot access configuration or alert management screens	Role test
AC-07	A scheduled PDF report is generated and delivered to the configured email recipient	End-to-end test
AC-08	Platform sustains polling of 10,000 interfaces for 24 hours without memory leak or performance degradation	Load test
AC-09	HA failover completes within 60 seconds with no data loss on the secondary node	Failover test
AC-10	RBAC user scoped to a device group cannot view devices outside that group	Role test
AC-11	Alert suppression correctly silences child-device alerts when the upstream parent is confirmed down	Integration test
AC-12	Audit log captures login, configuration change, and alert acknowledgement with user and timestamp	Audit test

SECTION 15

15 Risks & Constraints

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Monitoring gap during platform cutover	Medium	High	Mandatory 30-day parallel-run; vendor to confirm migration tooling
MIB compatibility issues with niche medical devices	Medium	Medium	Vendor must provide MIB browser, OID test tool, and escalation path for custom MIBs
Flow data volume exceeding platform processing capacity	Low	High	Vendor to provide capacity sizing guidance; confirm flow sampling support
Database storage growth exceeding projections	Medium	High	Vendor must provide configurable retention policies and auto-archive capability
ServiceNow integration requiring custom development	Low	Medium	Confirm native or documented REST API integration before contract award
Vendor financial instability or product discontinuation	Low	Very High	Require 3-year roadmap commitment; evaluate market standing and active customer base

SECTION 16

16 Vendor Response Instructions

16.1 Required Sections in Vendor Proposal

#	SECTION	CONTENT EXPECTED
1	**Company Overview**	Years in operation, GCC customer base, relevant certifications (ISO 27001, etc.)
2	**Product Overview**	Current product version, release cadence, 3-year roadmap summary
3	**Requirements Compliance Matrix**	Complete table mapping every FR and NFR in this document to: ✅ Natively supported / ⚠️ Via configuration / 🔧 Via customization / ❌ Not supported
4	**Architecture Overview**	Deployment diagram, HA design, supported OS, virtualization platforms, storage sizing
5	**Security & Compliance Statement**	Explicitly address NCA ECC 2018, encryption at rest/in-transit, audit logging, data residency
6	**Migration Approach**	Proposed transition plan with zero monitoring gap; parallel-run strategy and cutover approach
7	**POC Plan**	Proposed 30-day POC scope, success criteria, and resource requirements
8	**Customer References**	Minimum 2 enterprise references; GCC or healthcare sector preferred
9	**Commercial Proposal**	Itemized 3-year TCO, licensing model, support tiers, and payment options
10	**Support Model**	SLA commitments, escalation process, KSA/MENA region support availability

16.2 Submission Details

Submission Format
PDF or Word document submitted via email

Point of Contact
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Questions Deadline
Clarifications accepted up to 5 business days before the submission deadline

Submission Deadline
To be confirmed upon BRD distribution to shortlisted vendors

A

APPENDIX A

Priority Key

PRIORITY	DEFINITION	VENDOR IMPLICATION
Must Have	Critical requirement — the solution must support this natively or with minor configuration	Failure to meet a Must Have item **disqualifies** the vendor proposal
Should Have	Important but not disqualifying — absence will be scored against the vendor	Describe compensating capability or planned roadmap delivery date
Could Have	Nice to have — low weight in scoring; not expected in baseline proposal	Mention if natively available; no penalty if absent

B

APPENDIX B

Glossary

TERM	DEFINITION
SNMP	Simple Network Management Protocol — polls and manages network devices
NetFlow	Cisco protocol for exporting IP traffic metadata from routers and switches
sFlow	Vendor-neutral flow sampling protocol supported by HPE/Aruba and others
IPFIX	IETF-standardized flow export protocol (successor to NetFlow v9)
CDP	Cisco Discovery Protocol — Layer 2 protocol for discovering adjacent Cisco devices
LLDP	Link Layer Discovery Protocol — vendor-neutral equivalent of CDP
MIB	Management Information Base — SNMP OID database for a given device type
MTTR	Mean Time to Repair — average time to restore a failed service or device
MTBF	Mean Time Between Failures — average time between successive failures

TERM	DEFINITION
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control — permission model tying user roles to resource access
NCA ECC	Saudi Arabia National Cybersecurity Authority Essential Controls (2018)
NOC	Network Operations Center — team responsible for real-time network monitoring
HA	High Availability — system design eliminating single points of failure
TCO	Total Cost of Ownership — all costs over a defined ownership period
POC	Proof of Concept — time-limited evaluation of a vendor solution
ITSM	IT Service Management platform (e.g., ServiceNow)
TLS	Transport Layer Security — protocol for encrypted data transmission
SAML	Security Assertion Markup Language — standard for SSO federation

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